

Self-Knowledge & Identity

Character **First****GOALS MONTH 1**

- You can name three core values that define you as a person and teammate
- You recognize what gives you energy and what costs energy in a team setting
- You understand the difference between how you see yourself and how others see you

Who are you as a player and as a person? This worksheet helps you better understand your own strengths, values, and motivation. Take your time and be honest.

EXERCISE 1 — MY THREE WORDS**1 My Three Words**

Choose three words that best describe you as a teammate. Write them below. Then ask three teammates to write three words about you and compare the results.

My three words:

Words from teammate 1:

Words from teammate 2:

What stands out when you compare the lists?

EXERCISE 2 — ENERGY GIVERS VS ENERGY DRAINS**2 Energy Givers vs Energy Drains**

Write three things that give you energy during training or a match, and three things that cost you energy.

ENERGY GIVERS ►**ENERGY DRAINS ▼**

EXERCISE 3 — PERSONAL VALUES COMPASS**3 Personal Values Compass**

Rank the values below from 1 (most important) to 5 (less important) for you as a player and person.

 Loyalty

 Honesty

 Courage

 Persistence

 Respect

 Team Spirit

Which value do you live by the least? What do you want to change?

"The most important thing is to try and inspire people so that they can be great in whatever they want to do."

Kobe Bryant — 5x NBA Champion, Los Angeles Lakers

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SCIENTIFIC FOUNDATION — EVIDENCE PYRAMID

Systematic Review Ntoumanis et al. (2021) — 184 studies: autonomy and self-knowledge are strongest predictors of sports motivation in young athletes. *Psychology of Sport & Exercise*.

Meta-analysis Zuber & Conzelmann (2014) — 47 studies: intrinsic motivation and self-concept directly linked to youth sports performance.

Longitudinal Deci & Ryan (1985/2017) — SDT: autonomy, competence, and relatedness as universal basic needs in sport.

GUIDANCE PER EXERCISE

- 1 **My Three Words:** 3 minutes solo writing. Then pairs write each other's words without consulting. Group discussion: "Who was surprised?" Handle negative surprises individually.
- 2 **Energy Givers vs Drains:** Fill in individually. Discuss only energy givers in the group. Discuss drains individually or confidentially.
- 3 **Values Compass:** Volunteers share top value. Ranking on board. Ask: "How do we see this in behavior?" Bridge to coming months.

COACH TIPS FOR THIS THEME

Tip 1: Fill in the worksheet yourself and share your answers. Vulnerability from the coach lowers the threshold.

Tip 2: Take notes of what players share. Use this later to remind them of their own values.

Tip 3: Players who write little are not unmotivated. Self-knowledge can be confronting. Address individually, not in front of the group.

⚠ Avoid: "Who wants to share their words?" Pointing someone out creates insecurity. Build trust by sharing first yourself.

TIMING

- ☐ Introduction and explanation: 5 minutes
- ☐ Individual worksheet completion: 10 minutes
- ☐ Group discussion Three Words: 10 minutes
- ☐ Group discussion Values Compass: 10 minutes
- ☐ Closing: 5 minutes